



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Sierra Leone: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-20

Edition of 2026-08-20-2 · 79 systems and instruments tracked, 11 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-20 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

Of 79 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 37 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-20, 15 did not, 16 carry no stated baseline, and 11 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 72 sources for this place in the window — 13 in the earlier half (2025-10 to 2026-02), 59 in the later (2026-03 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

Over the twelve months to 9 August 2026 Sierra Leone added physical and institutional capacity and left the rules governing it where they were. Two data centres entered service, a second payments generation was contracted, an identity partnership was signed and a first national artificial intelligence strategy went into drafting. No data-protection statute was enacted, no rule allocating loss for mobile-money fraud was made, and the Electronic Transactions Act that has been in force since December 2019 was still being prepared for use. The shape check above is the qualification on all of it: the earlier half of the window holds 13 sources against 44 in the later half, so most of what is recorded as movement was recorded late in the period.

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                              | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                     | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| CSquared West Africa backbone and 2Africa West capacity | Backbone reaching Sierra Leone with no independent 2Africa route (2025-07) | 2Africa West capacity added, giving automated rerouting across physically diverse paths (2026-07) | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>National fibre backbone (SALCAB)</b>                           | International capacity reported at 500+ Gbps after the SALCAB privatisation, up from 90 Gbps; no district count published (2025-07)                | Fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\$400m invested in telecoms, with a 60% usage gap (2026-05)                                                           | ADVANCED, MARGINAL |
| <b>Sierratel relaunch as an MVNO</b>                              | State telco carrying about US\$6.3m in employee obligations and about US\$35m external debt after failed privatisations, with no partner (2025-07) | Revenue-share MVNO model agreed with Africell, which held 54.51% market share at end-2024; no relaunch date published (2026-04)                                   | ADVANCED           |
| <b>Starlink connectivity for 300 government health facilities</b> | Did not exist                                                                                                                                      | One of 300 facilities connected; cost, funder, procurement route, contract term and data-residency arrangement all unpublished (2026-07)                          | ADVANCED           |
| <b>Starlink licensed satellite service</b>                        | Licensed and operating; 12 universities connected through ELCOME SL (2025-01)                                                                      | Two years licensed with three resellers, and the state buying it for health facilities (2026)                                                                     | ADVANCED           |
| <b>Second submarine cable landing</b>                             | Feasibility assessment under way, no landing party or route (2025-07)                                                                              | Still at feasibility, with a US\$15m investment cited at 2026 stakeholder meetings; no route, landing party or date published                                     | NO CHANGE          |
| <b>SOGEB-Leonecom fibre interconnection at Pamelap</b>            | Interconnected at 42.5 Gbps under the Guinea-Sierra Leone Digital Pact 2024 (2025-06)                                                              | 42.5 Gbps, with 100 Gbps stated for 2026; no upgrade confirmed on the record                                                                                      | NO CHANGE          |
| <b>Spectrum licensing and management framework</b>                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                           | Regulator seeking 15-20-year licences, staggered spectrum fees, NGSO guidelines and an automated spectrum management system; none adopted on the record (2026-03) | Baseline not held  |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                                 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>National Data Centre at NatCA headquarters</b> | Ten-storey building under construction since 2015, not commissioned (2025-07) | Commissioned, housing the National Data Centre and network operations and co-locating NaTCA with MoCTI (2026-04)           | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Orange Bo backup data centre</b>               | Did not exist; one commercial data centre in Freetown (2018)                  | EUR 23m disaster-recovery replica of the Freetown facility in service, alongside a US\$50m network modernisation (2025-11) | ADVANCED          |
| <b>NCRA Tier III data centre</b>                  | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                      | Reported as Tier III-compliant and carrying the national biometric register; no certification document held (2026-08)      | Baseline not held |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                   | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>RESPITE solar and storage plant</b> | Not held      | A World Bank-funded 40MW solar-plus-storage project at Lungi and Newton fully operational, commissioned in July 2026 and projected to raise the electricity access rate toward 36% and ease outages affecting telecommunications and digital services | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| NaTCA consumer education campaign on online fraud      | Did not exist      | Advisory campaign running; no rule-making, SIM-swap control, operator obligation or complaint remedy announced alongside it (2026-07)                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED          |
| Operator scam-alert reporting tool                     | Did not exist      | A mobile operator's reporting channel for suspected fraud against its mobile-money service, reached on a *505# USSD short code, an online form or a 111 call, and presented as customer protection alongside the wallet's transfer, bill-payment, savings and credit services | ADVANCED          |
| Regulator response to the 2026 cybersecurity incidents | Did not exist      | Coordinated response announced with no attribution, no named affected service, no incident count, no start date and no severity assessment (2026-07)                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED          |
| Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021                      | In force (2025-07) | In force and unamended; no prosecution under it is reported in the base (2026-07)                                                                                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE         |
| National Cyber Security Coordination Centre (NC3)      | BASELINE NOT HELD  | Operating and named in the government's fraud response; no founding instrument, mandate or budget held (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                              | Baseline not held |

The two additions that changed the country's physical position both opened in the period. Orange [opened a EUR 23m disaster-recovery replica of its Freetown facility in Bo on 29 November 2025](#), and the state [commissioned the National Data Centre at the NaTCA headquarters on 17 April 2026](#) after a build begun in 2015. Both were framed by their principals as resilience and custody rather than capacity, and neither party publishes rack count, load or utilisation.

The backbone moved little and was measured for the first time: [fibre in 14 of 16 districts against about US\\$400m invested, with a 60% usage gap](#) as at May 2026. The [Pamelap interconnection with Guinea stayed at 42.5 Gbps with the 100 Gbps stated for 2026 unconfirmed](#), and the [second submarine landing did not move past feasibility](#). Redundancy that did arrive came from a wholesale carrier rather than from national investment, when CSquared [added 2Africa West capacity to the backbone reaching the country in July 2026](#).

The state telco found a route out of its balance sheet without capital: Africell was [appointed investment partner for a revenue-share MVNO relaunch in April 2026](#), with no relaunch date published.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                         | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                             | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>ASYCUDA customs system</b>                                | In service as the customs declaration system, with no integrity finding on record                                         | In service, with the anti-corruption commission finding over 300 billion leones lost to backend manipulation - processed customs declarations deliberately deleted and dormant bank-teller profiles used to validate transactions after the account holders had left their institutions - and reasonable grounds to suspect coordinated collusion. The commission's own text puts the mechanism as clearing agents' payments being unlawfully deleted from the revenue authority's tax system after the funds had reached government-designated bank accounts, leaving significant discrepancies between what the banks collected and what the system recorded, and suspects revenue-authority staff acting in collusion with tellers at the commercial banks that processed the payments | REGRESSED |
| <b>Government Service Bus and X-Road data exchange layer</b> | World Bank terms of reference for an open-source prototype in the Ministry of Finance data centre; nothing running (2025) | Data Exchange Layer piloting on X-Road under the Ministry of Finance; no production date, connected agencies or governance rules published (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED  |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                       | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                      | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>MOSIP migration of the national identity system</b>                     | Brownfield migration of enrolled records onto open-source MOSIP, piloted from early 2024 (2025-07) | Pilot complete and full implementation unfunded, as stated by the Authority (2026-08)                                                                                                            | ADVANCED, UNFUNDED |
| <b>National digital identity platform (Bhutan NDI and SIGN Foundation)</b> | A bilateral blockchain digital-identity memorandum with Sign and nothing built (2025-11)           | Tri-party memorandum signed June 2026, MOSIP-based register with W3C verifiable credentials specified, and consultations opened; no framework, legal instrument or timetable published (2026-08) | ADVANCED           |
| <b>SIM registration linked to the National Identification Number</b>       | Did not exist as an enforced link (2025-07)                                                        | Named as the government's principal enforcement lever against mobile-money fraud while not all subscribers have a verified NIN linked (2026-08)                                                  | ADVANCED           |
| <b>National Identification Number and biometric identity register</b>      | 93% registration coverage reported, 6.4m NIN holders against an 8.8m target (2025-06)              | About 93% coverage with a unique NIN each, backed by a Tier III data centre and a live eKYC platform (2026-08)                                                                                   | NO CHANGE          |
| <b>National identity card issuance</b>                                     | Under 0.5m cards issued against 6.4m NIN holders, at a fee of US\$6-7 (2024)                       | No issuance figure published since 2024                                                                                                                                                          | NO CHANGE          |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Afrimoney prepaid Visa card (Africell, with Ecobank)</b> | Did not exist | Prepaid card in service, issued against the Afrimoney wallet (2026-05)                               | ADVANCED |
| <b>Flot payments platform and chatbot (Open Hub)</b>        | Did not exist | In service with multi-channel card and mobile-money acceptance and a no-code store builder (2026-04) | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                           | AT 2025-08-01                                            | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>MikashBoks Interest Plus savings product (with Ecobank)</b>                 | Did not exist                                            | In service, deposits held in an Ecobank master account, 80% UK-investor funded (2025-11)                               | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Orange Money virtual Mastercard (with Zenith Bank)</b>                      | Did not exist                                            | Virtual card in service for online, international and cross-border payments (2026-03)                                  | ADVANCED          |
| <b>National instant payment switch</b>                                         | Live with seven banks and two mobile operators (2025-04) | In service; no transaction volume, participant count or availability figure published for 2026                         | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Mobile-money fraud complaints logged by Orange Sierra Leone</b>             | BASELINE NOT HELD                                        | About 390 complaints in 2026 to date (2026-08)                                                                         | Baseline not held |
| <b>Police requests for subscriber KYC data answered by Orange Sierra Leone</b> | BASELINE NOT HELD                                        | More than 18,000 requests answered in 2026 to date, which the ministry states are not all cybercrime-related (2026-08) | Baseline not held |
| <b>Vult multi-currency wallet and card (Velmie, Metro Cable)</b>               | BASELINE NOT HELD                                        | In service; no user, merchant or volume figure published since launch (2026)                                           | Baseline not held |

## Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                             | AT 2025-08-01                                                                    | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>National Digital Farmer Registry</b>                                                          | Integration with the national identity system agreed under Feed Salone (2025-05) | No enrolment figure, launch or completion date published since (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Integrated National Digital Mortality Surveillance, Registration and Certification System</b> | Not held                                                                         | In procurement by the national public health agency with the health ministry and the civil registration authority, aligned to WHO ICD-11 and building on a national health information hub established in January 2026, against a registration gap in which only 13.4% of deaths are fully registered | BASELINE NOT HELD |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                       | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Digital health information system and electronic medical records</b> | Paper-based patient records, with no national electronic medical record programme on file (2025-07) | Programme announced covering electronic medical records, disease surveillance and telemedicine across 300 facilities, beginning with one (2026-07) | ADVANCED |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                  | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT           |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>Electronic government procurement platform</b> | No e-procurement programme on record (2025-07) | Study tour to Liberia completed and bilateral cooperation on digital transformation and procurement transparency deepened with the Liberian regulator, reported 2026-08-12; no platform, procurement decision or timetable is published | ADVANCED, MARGINAL |
| <b>Digitisation of government services</b>        | 80% of services reported digitised (2025-06)   | No later figure published; the 2024 UN e-government ranking of 172 of 193 is the only external measure held                                                                                                                             | NO CHANGE          |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                  | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | MOVEMENT                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| National Monitoring and Evaluation Information System | Not held      | Being expanded by the national monitoring and evaluation agency for real-time remote tracking of the 100 to 250 public projects launched each year                                                                                                                                                                                    | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| SierraSeat audit management information system        | Not held      | In final user-acceptance testing after post-configuration training on 3 to 5 August 2026, built for the state audit service with World Bank funding by customising a platform of the African organisation of English-speaking supreme audit institutions, ahead of the service declaring it operational and moving it into production | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Rural digital data capture

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Agricultural interactive voice response platform | Not held      | An upgraded interactive voice response platform reported 98% complete, to give farmers direct access to agriculture ministry officials under the national food-security agenda | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                         | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                      | MOVEMENT        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Coordination and Visualization Platform (DSTI with Catholic Relief Services) | Did not exist | Platform launched with a spatial data science workshop for 60 officials covering hazard mapping and inter-agency data governance (2026-07)                                         | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| National base map (DSTI with JICA and Aero Toyota)                           | Did not exist | Phase one covering Western Area Urban District, built on OpenStreetMap with Japanese technical direction; no cost, timetable, hosting arrangement or data licence stated (2026-08) | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

Identity gained specification and lost none of its ambiguity. The register itself did not move — about 93% coverage was reported in June 2025 and again in August 2026 — while the ministry signed a tri-party memorandum with Bhutan's National Digital Identity and the SIGN Foundation in June 2026 and settled its specifications in August: a MOSIP-based register and W3C verifiable credentials. The registrar's own MOSIP migration reached the end of its pilot and stopped for want of funding. Card issuance, the one measure of whether enrolment reaches people, has no figure published since the under 0.5m recorded for 2024.

Payments moved at the front of the stack and not, on the record, beneath it. Four card and wallet products entered service between November 2025 and May 2026, ending with the Afrimoney prepaid Visa card. A re-platforming of the rails themselves is reported to have been contracted in August 2026, but neither the central bank nor the procurement authority publishes an award notice, so the base does not carry it and the row stands unheld. The switch launched in February 2025 has published no volume figure for 2026.

Interoperability advanced from paper to pilot, the Ministry of Finance moving from a World Bank terms of reference to a data exchange layer piloting on X-Road. Geospatial capability was created from nothing, with a platform launched in July 2026 with Catholic Relief Services and a national base map begun with JICA in August 2026.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Electronic Transactions Act 2019</b>                   | In force since 5 December 2019 with no certification authorities, evidence procedures, dispute mechanisms or penalties established (2025-07) | A gap analysis, policy memorandum and implementation roadmap commissioned under the READY Salone project running to 2028; no adoption date for any of the three (2026-07)                                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Subscribers Regulations 2025 (SIM-NIN enforcement)</b> | Did not exist; the 2020 Subscribers Identification and Registration Management Regulations were the instrument on file (2025-07)             | Operators fined 25,000 new leones per unregistered or pre-activated SIM, with a staged disconnection ladder; the six-month transition clock is presented as running from the announcement, so the phase-out date is unestablished (2026-07) | ADVANCED  |
| <b>National Communications Authority Act 2022</b>         | In force, with enforcement powers addressed to licensees (2025-07)                                                                           | In force and unamended; the analysis finds its powers bind licensees only, leaving foreign platforms outside the perimeter, and identifies s.194 as the route to close the gaps without new primary legislation (2026-07)                   | NO CHANGE |

### Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01                                                         | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT  |
|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Multi-agency response to mobile-money fraud</b> | Did not exist                                                         | Three pillars announced - public education, institutional strengthening, better investigation and prosecution - with no new instrument (2026-08); a two-day national workshop on 18 and 19 August brought the central bank, the telecom and mobile-money operators and the cybersecurity bodies together to draft a roadmap, after parliamentary pressure over identity-theft scams on one operator's network | ADVANCED  |
| <b>National Data Protection Policy</b>             | Did not exist                                                         | Approved, covering collection, processing, storage and sharing of personal data; the text itself is not published (2026-04)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | ADVANCED  |
| <b>National Data Strategy</b>                      | Updated and aligned to the African Union Data Policy Framework (2025) | No implementation report, institutional owner or review date published since (2026-08)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | NO CHANGE |

### Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                           | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                     | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Sierra Leone-Guinea free roaming agreement</b> | Did not exist                                                           | Agreement signed under the Smart Africa single digital market; no commencement date or tariff published (2025-11) | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone free roaming</b>   | In effect, home SIM at local rates across the three countries (2025-05) | In effect; no traffic or price data published (2026-08)                                                           | NO CHANGE |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-20                                                     | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>National open-source software policy for the public sector</b> | Approved as the country's first such policy (2025) | In force; no compliance or adoption reporting published (2026-07) | NO CHANGE |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                        | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data Protection and Right to Access Information Bill</b> | No data-protection statute; a draft Bill in consultation (2025-07)                                   | Cabinet approval given and the Bill to be finalised with the Attorney-General and tabled; not enacted, and no parliamentary date set (2026-04)                       | ADVANCED |
| <b>Right to Access Information Commission</b>               | Operating under the Right to Access Information Commission Act, access to information only (2025-07) | To be transformed into a single authority for both access to information and data protection, with investigative and enforcement powers; awaiting the Bill (2026-04) | ADVANCED |

The governance layer is where the period's movement was thinnest relative to activity. Data protection advanced one stage without reaching the statute book: from a [validated draft in November 2025](#) to [Cabinet approval of a policy and authorisation of a Bill on 21 April 2026](#), with the Bill still to be tabled. Sierra Leone had no data-protection law in force at either end of the window.

The Electronic Transactions Act moved from unimplemented to [being prepared for implementation, through a dialogue of 27-28 July 2026 that is to produce a gap analysis, a policy memorandum and a roadmap](#) with no adoption date. The National Communications Authority Act 2022 and the Cyber Security and Crime Act 2021 both [ended the period in force and unamended](#), tested against a fraud wave they were found not to cover. No rule allocating loss for mobile-money fraud existed at either end.

What did change is enforcement through the register: the [Subscribers Regulations 2025 were announced on 30 July 2026 with a per-SIM penalty of 25,000 new leones and a staged disconnection ladder](#), on a transition clock whose start date is unestablished. Regionally, the [Guinea free-roaming agreement was signed in November 2025](#) with no commencement date published.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>AI-in-government partnership with Qhala</b>      | Did not exist | Memorandum to train 500 civil servants and build 10-15 AI workflows; 50+ senior leaders trained by March 2026, no workflow delivery reported (2026-03)                                                                    | ADVANCED |
| <b>Deepfake and digital misinformation campaign</b> | Did not exist | Campaign running in Freetown, Makeni, Port Loko, Magburaka, Bo, Kenema and Kono, with broadcast programming and a verification chatbot announced as the next phase; no budget, funder or completion date stated (2026-07) | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT        | AT 2025-08-01                                              | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>National AI Strategy</b> | No AI strategy or readiness assessment on record (2025-07) | First National AI Strategy in drafting with the World Bank, a draft readiness diagnostic produced, and consultations run on local languages and cultural context; not adopted (2026-05) | ADVANCED |

## ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                                | AT 2025-08-01                                                                      | AT 2026-08-20                                                            | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Millennium Challenge Corporation compact dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades</b> | Provided for in the compact, transmission and distribution dispatch centres (2024) | No commissioning, milestone or delivery report published since (2026-08) | NO CHANGE |

Artificial intelligence policy went from nothing on record to a drafting programme. The [memorandum with Qhala](#) was signed in October 2025 to train 500 civil servants and build 10-15 AI workflows, and a first National AI Strategy entered drafting with the World Bank, with a draft readiness diagnostic produced by May 2026. Neither has produced an adopted instrument or a delivered workflow on the record.

The state's answer to synthetic media was created within the window and is not a rule: a [campaign running since May 2026 across seven towns](#), with no accompanying legislative or platform-facing instrument. The compact-funded [dispatch centres and SCADA upgrades](#) report no milestone at either end.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                    | AT 2025-08-01                                         | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT          |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Internet penetration</b>             | 20.7% of the population online, 1.84m users (2025-01) | 20.8% online, 1.85m users against 7.02m offline (2025-10)                                                              | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Telecom investment against usage</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                              | About US\$400m invested against a 60% usage gap, with 1GB at Le 18,000-25,000, roughly triple the 2018 price (2026-05) | Baseline not held |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                              | AT 2025-08-01                                                        | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Financial inclusion rate</b>                   | 18% of adults (2018)                                                 | About 40% of adults (2025)                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED          |
| <b>Starlink connectivity for universities</b>     | 12 universities connected, extending to vocational schools (2025-01) | No further site count or extension reported (2026-08)                                                                                                                      | NO CHANGE         |
| <b>Human intermediation in identity enrolment</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                             | Enrolment of the undocumented depends on chiefs, teachers and justices of the peace issuing affidavits that the NCRA accepts at face value (2026-03)                       | Baseline not held |
| <b>Smartphone financing scheme</b>                | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                             | A 24-month device-financing scheme open to individual and business customers, run by an operator with a commercial bank on top of their existing prepaid card relationship | Baseline not held |

## Training and skills

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT          |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Civil service digital skills programme     | Did not exist     | Running, with 1,000 civil servants in year one and targets of 3,000 medium-term and 5,000 long-term across six areas (2026-07)                             | ADVANCED          |
| Digital Public Goods university curriculum | Did not exist     | More than 1,100 students taught, 14 campus champions across four universities, and 11 student-built solutions evaluated against the DPG Standard (2026-07) | ADVANCED          |
| Youth digital-literacy programme at Kenema | BASELINE NOT HELD | Eighty young people graduated from a nine-month course, with graduates reporting job retention and promotion                                               | Baseline not held |

Skills capacity was built at both the civil-service and university levels, through a programme launched in July 2026 with 1,000 places in year one and a Digital Public Goods curriculum that has taught more than 1,100 students. Access did not move with them: 12 universities remain the reported extent of Starlink connectivity for the sector, and the last penetration figure held is 20.8% in October 2025.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-20                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| WARDIP2 regional digital integration operation | Did not exist     | Approved across Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, targeting 5.2m people connected and digital skills training for 9,000; the Sierra Leone share is not disclosed (2026-03) | ADVANCED          |
| Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund        | BASELINE NOT HELD | US\$150m over five years stated as a mobilisation target, with no amount raised stated (2026-07)                                                                          | Baseline not held |

External finance was committed and domestic finance was announced within the period. The World Bank Board approved the US\$137m WARDIP2 operation on 13 March 2026 covering Benin, Liberia and Sierra Leone, with the Sierra Leone share undisclosed; the Sierra Leone Innovation Investment Fund appeared in July 2026 as a US\$150m five-year target with no amount raised.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                               | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                      | LAST PROBED    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Allocation of loss for mobile-money fraud                          | Two published analyses disagree on whether the problem is absent law or unenforced law; unreconciled as at 2026-08-09.                    | not yet probed |
| Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital estate | A staffing, skills-audit or operations report from NaTCA, DSTI or the NCRA covering who runs the national systems and with what capacity. | not yet probed |
| Digitalisation of local councils                                   | A local government digital plan, a council-level service platform, or a district administration report on digital service delivery.       | not yet probed |
| European Union digital cooperation with Sierra Leone               | A Global Gateway or EU delegation announcement, a financing agreement, or a programme document naming Sierra Leone.                       | not yet probed |
| Indian digital cooperation with Sierra Leone                       | A bilateral memorandum, a line-of-credit agreement, or an India Stack or ITEC programme document naming Sierra Leone.                     | not yet probed |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                           | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | LAST PROBED    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Gulf state digital investment in Sierra Leone</b>                           | An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | not yet probed |
| <b>Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector</b>                   | The Ministry of Finance appropriation act or budget speech showing the votes for MoCTI, NaTCA, DSTI and the NCRA.                                                                                                                                                                                                                | not yet probed |
| <b>NCRA-SLRSA register-to-register data-sharing agreement</b>                  | The signed agreement or a published summary stating what data classes flow, on what legal basis and with what retention limit.                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2026-08-09     |
| <b>Legal basis for data sharing between government registers</b>               | A data-sharing instrument, regulation or protocol governing exchanges between the identity register and other agencies.                                                                                                                                                                                                          | not yet probed |
| <b>United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement</b> | The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Sierra Leonean government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia                         | not yet probed |
| <b>Bank of Sierra Leone RTGS and ACH re-platforming</b>                        | An award notice from the Bank of Sierra Leone or the National Public Procurement Authority for references 8922483/8922484, naming supplier, value and scope. The only listing found was an inadmissible-origin tender aggregator, retired 2026-08-10; neither contracting authority's procurement page carries a matching entry. | 2026-08-10     |

Nine rows carry no position at either end. Six are subjects the base holds nothing on for Sierra Leone, and three are documents the record points at without containing them. None was probed within this period; each is carried into the next.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-20-2</b>                                                                                                                                                     |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress.html</a>                         |
| THIS FILE       | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress-2026-08-20-2.pdf">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SLE/SLE-progress-2026-08-20-2.pdf</a> |
| LICENCE         | <a href="#">CC BY 4.0</a>                                                                                                                                               |

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.